Start a local game server

Brieltje on your own laptop for a LAN night.

Players type

`https://lan.brieltje.be`

1 Once, at home needs the internet

Docker

1. Install Docker Desktop (docker.com).
2. Start it. Wait until it says it is running.

Cloudflare token

1. Open **dash.cloudflare.com**.
2. Go to Manage Account › Account API Tokens. My Profile › API Tokens works too.
3. Create Token. Pick the **Edit zone DNS** template.
4. Add a second permission: `Zone` · `Zone` · `Read`.
5. Zone Resources: `Specific zone` · `brieltje.be`.
6. Leave IP filtering empty.
7. Create the token. Copy it. Cloudflare shows it only once.

First start

1. Double-click `lan.cmd` in the game's folder.
2. The first time it builds Caddy. That takes a few minutes.
3. Paste the token at *The token (not shown)*. Right-click pastes. Nothing shows on screen.
4. Answer the questions (see step 3).
5. Wait for *Certificate valid until ….*
6. Press `Enter` to stop.

> The certificate lasts 90 days. Caddy renews it whenever lan.cmd runs with internet. Start once at home in the weeks before a night.

2 The network once per venue

Router

- Give the laptop a fixed address with a DHCP reservation.
- Put the laptop on a cable if you can.
- Players' Wi-Fi must let devices reach each other. Turn off client isolation.

Local DNS

- Add one A record: `lan.brieltje.be` → the laptop's address.
- Only that name. Not a whole zone.
- Allow that name past the router's rebinding protection.

> lan.cmd also points the public record at the laptop on every start with internet. Phones that skip your DNS still find it that way.

3 On the night

Start

1. Start Docker Desktop.
2. Double-click `lan.cmd`.
3. Answer its questions:

Which network?	`Enter` takes the first. It is usually right.
Make it Private?	Type `y` on your own network.
Fix the firewall?	`Enter`. Then Yes in the Windows prompt.
Admin password	At least 8 characters. Only for tonight.

4. Wait until it shows *Players type this.*

Run the evening

- Players: `https://lan.brieltje.be`
- You: `/admin/`. Log in as admin. Then **Host**.
- Big screen: `/admin/scores/`. Press `F` for full screen.
- Watch players: `/admin/watch/`. One player, or four side by side.
- Leave the lan.cmd window open. It follows a change of network on its own.

Stop

- Press `Enter` or `Q` in the lan.cmd window.
- Accounts stay in Docker for next time. Tonight's scores start fresh.

4 When something goes wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
Docker is not running	Start Docker Desktop. Wait until it runs. Start lan.cmd again.
A phone finds no site at lan.brieltje.be	Check the local DNS record. It must point at the laptop's address. Check the rebinding exception.
The name is found. The page doesn't load.	Windows keeps players out. Close lan.cmd. Start it again. Answer `y` to Private and `Enter` to the firewall.
A phone on Wi-Fi can't reach it. A laptop on cable can.	Client isolation is on for that Wi-Fi. Turn it off in the access point.
Cloudflare refused the token	Make a new token. Start `lan.cmd -NewToken` and paste it.
Port 443 is in use by ...	Close the program it names. Start lan.cmd again.
No internet and no certificate	Best: start once where there is internet. Or type `y` for plain http. Players then type the address it shows. Passwords then travel unencrypted.
This computer's address changed	lan.cmd moves the public record itself. Update the local DNS record to the new address.
Caddy keeps stopping	Stop with `Enter`. Start lan.cmd again. Its log is in the folder below.
The certificate runs out within three weeks	Start lan.cmd once with internet. Caddy renews it.

5 Options

Run them in a terminal in the game's folder, for example `.\lan.cmd -Http`.

OPTION	WHAT IT DOES
`-Address 192.168.1.10`	Uses this address instead of the one it picks.
`-Http`	Plain http on the laptop's address. No name. No certificate.
`-Http -Port 8090`	Plain http on another port.
`-NewToken`	Asks for the Cloudflare token again.
`-Domain spel.brieltje.be`	Another name under brieltje.be. It gets its own certificate.
`-Staging`	Let's Encrypt's test service. Browsers don't trust it. Only for trying out.

6 Where things are

WHAT	WHERE
Caddy, the certificate, the token	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\brieltje-lan`. The token is encrypted for your Windows account.
Players, accounts, rules	The Docker volume `brieltje-lan_brieltje-lan-data`.
Caddy's log	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\brieltje-lan\caddy.log`
More detail	`docs/DETAILS.md`, "A LAN night".

> Keep the token to yourself. If it ever leaks, roll it in Cloudflare. Then start `lan.cmd -NewToken`.